When the Wolves Came Back
山脊之上，狼影再临

第一段

For decades, the gray **wolf** had been gone from Yellowstone. Without **predators**, this land became a paradise for elk. But **with it came a cost**: the park's ecosystem fell into **disorder**. The elk **population** exploded, the **surplus** soon straining the ecosystem. They **gnawed at** the **bark without restraint**, leaving trunks bare. As a result, many trees died. Deprived of shade, the **moss** around the trees slowly **withered** and vanished under the **scorching sun**. The damage these **herbivores** caused to the ecosystem was like a deep, gaping **wound** that would not **heal**.

第二段

To **prevent** the situation **from** getting worse, in 1995, officials decided to **reintroduce** wolves. Upon hearing the news, **ranchers** were **indignant**. They **were skeptical about** whether this decision would actually be **carried out**. **To head this off**, ranchers **banded together**, **objecting** to this plan and demanding **hearings**. They claimed this was an **insult** to their way of life, as wolves would **prey on** their **livestock**. If wolves returned, the constant struggle to **resist** these **vicious** predators would **torment** them **endlessly**. However, ecologists **took the opposite view**. They **cared little for** how the **shepherds** felt; all they wanted was for Yellowstone to **revive**.

第三段

The plan that many had deemed **dubious** went ahead as scheduled, yet the results far exceeded **estimates**. Elk no longer **dared to roam** near the open **ridges**, for **cunning** gray wolves now **lurked** there, ready to **pursue** them at any moment. Free from relentless grazing, greenery returned, its rapid **expansion** soon transforming the entire **panorama**. Where elk had left the land **desolate**, new life now **stretched** across it once more—**lush** and **thriving**. In a Yellowstone reborn, beavers also **made their way back**—to **swamp** and stream.

第四段

Yellowstone's **rebirth** brought unexpected **clarity** on how to **maintain ecological balance** in the future. The key lay not in killing, but in fear. Gray wolves do more than just kill elk and control their numbers; their fierce **disposition instills** lasting fear in their **prey**. As a result, elk now **wander** within a limited range, doing everything they can to avoid places where wolves **howl**. This greatly shrinks the area damaged by elk **grazing**, giving other areas time to recover. It is this behavioral shift that **underlies** much of the **restoration**.

第五段

The **resounding** success soon rippled beyond ecology. Visitors arrived in growing numbers, **hiking** along the valley **rim at their leisure**, hoping to **catch a glimpse of** the **elusive** gray wolves. Local tourism operators **scored** big—**abundant** revenue **poured in**, giving the economy a significant boost. Ranchers, however, were **up in arms**. As wolf populations grew, so did livestock kills. Some ranchers began organizing hunts on their own. To **defuse** the **rising tensions**, authorities were forced to introduce a **compensation** policy: ranchers who lost livestock could now **file claims**. This **concession** helped **soften** the opposition.

第六段

Other regions now **pursue** similar outcomes. In Germany, wolves have crossed the **border** from Poland—and the boost to ecosystem recovery is already visible. Farmers, though, have **groaned** over their **mounting** losses and **pointed fingers at** government policy. In response, **Parliament** drew up **clauses** to safeguard their interests and property. The **entity** responsible for overseeing wildlife **conceded** limited culls—but kept core populations **intact**.

第七段

Ecologists **counsel** patience. **After all**, ecosystem recovery is not **instantaneous**—it takes decades to restore the **delicate bonds** between species. Yet for all this complexity, Yellowstone offers a **concise** lesson: remove a keystone species, the balance collapses; **revive** it, nature **heals** itself.

翻译：

第一段

For decades, the gray **wolf** had been gone from Yellowstone. 近几十年来，灰**狼**已经从黄石公园消失了。

Without **predators**, this land became a paradise for elk. 没有了**捕食者**，这片土地成了麋鹿的天堂。

But **with it came a cost**: the park's ecosystem fell into **disorder**. 但**随之而来的代价是**：公园的生态系统陷入了**混乱。**

The elk **population** exploded, the **surplus** soon straining the ecosystem. 麋鹿的**数量**激增，**过剩**的种群很快给生态系统带来了巨大压力。

They **gnawed at** the **bark without restraint**, leaving trunks bare. 它们**肆无忌惮**地**啃食**树**皮**，把树干啃得光秃秃的。

As a result, many trees died. 结果，许多树木死亡了。

Deprived of shade, the **moss** around the trees slowly **withered** and vanished under the **scorching sun**. 失去了树荫的遮蔽，树木周围的**苔藓**在**烈日**下慢慢**枯萎**并消失。

The damage these **herbivores** caused to the ecosystem was like a deep, gaping **wound** that would not **heal**. 这些**食草动物**对生态系统造成的破坏，就像一道深深的、张开的**伤口**，久久无法**愈合。**

第二段

To **prevent** the situation **from** getting worse, in 1995, officials decided to **reintroduce** wolves. 为了**防止**情况**进一步**恶化，1995年，官方决定**重新引入**狼群。

Upon hearing the news, **ranchers** were **indignant**. 听到这个消息，**牧场主**们**愤愤不平。**

They **were skeptical about** whether this decision would actually be **carried out**. 他们**对**这一决定是否真的会被**执行 持怀疑态度。**

To head this off, ranchers **banded together**, **objecting** to this plan and demanding **hearings**. **为了阻止这一切**，牧场主们**联合起来**，**反对**这项计划，并要求举行**听证会。**

They claimed this was an **insult** to their way of life, as wolves would **prey on** their **livestock**. 他们声称这是对他们生活方式的**侮辱**，因为狼会**捕食**他们的**牲畜。**

If wolves returned, the constant struggle to **resist** these **vicious** predators would **torment** them **endlessly**. 如果狼回来了，为了**抵御**这些**凶残的**捕食者而进行的持续斗争将会**无休止**地**折磨**他们。

However, ecologists **took the opposite view**. 然而，生态学家们**持相反的观点。**

They **cared little for** how these **shepherds** felt; all they wanted was for Yellowstone to **revive**. 他们**不太在乎 这些 牧羊人**的感受；他们只想让黄石公园**恢复生机。**

第三段

The plan that many had deemed **dubious** went ahead as scheduled, yet the results far exceeded **estimates**. 这项被许多人认为**不靠谱的**计划如期推进，而结果却远远超出了**预期。**

Elk no longer **dared to roam** near the open **ridges**, for **cunning** gray wolves now **lurked** there, ready to **pursue** them at any moment. 麋鹿不再 **敢 在**开阔的**山脊**附近**漫步**，因为**狡猾的**灰狼如今**潜伏**在那里，随时准备**追捕**它们。

Free from **relentless** grazing, greenery returned, its rapid **expansion** soon transforming the entire **panorama**. 摆脱了**无休止的**啃食，绿色植被回归了，它的快速**扩张**很快改变了整个**景观。**

Where elk had left the land **desolate**, new life now **stretched** across it once more—**lush** and **thriving**. 在麋鹿曾经使土地变得**荒芜**的地方，新的生命如今再次**蔓延**开来——**郁郁葱葱**，**生机勃勃。**

In a Yellowstone reborn, beavers also **made their way back**—to **swamp** and stream. 在重生的黄石公园里，海狸也**回来了**——回到**沼泽**和溪流中。

第四段

Yellowstone's **rebirth** brought unexpected **clarity** on how to **maintain ecological balance** in the future. 黄石公园的**重生**为未来如何**维持生态平衡**带来了意想不到的**清晰认识。**

The key lay not in killing, but in fear. 关键不在于杀戮，而在于恐惧。

Gray wolves do more than just kill elk and control their numbers; their fierce **disposition instills** lasting fear in their **prey**. 灰狼所做的不仅仅是猎杀麋鹿、控制它们的数量；它们凶猛的**性情**还会在**猎物**心中**灌输**持久的恐惧。

As a result, elk now **wander** within a limited range, doing everything they can to avoid places where wolves **howl**. 因此，麋鹿现在只在有限的范围内**游荡**，尽一切可能避开狼群**嚎叫**的地方。

This greatly shrinks the area damaged by elk **grazing**, giving other areas time to recover. 这大大缩小了被麋鹿**啃食**破坏的区域，让其他地方有了恢复的时间。

It is this behavioral shift that **underlies** much of the **restoration**. 正是这种行为转变**构成了**大部分生态**恢复**的基础。

第五段

The **resounding** success soon rippled beyond ecology. 这一**巨大的**成功很快波及到了生态领域之外。

Visitors arrived in growing numbers, **hiking** along the valley **rim at their leisure**, hoping to **catch a glimpse of** the **elusive** gray wolves. 游客们纷至沓来，**悠闲地**沿着山谷的**边缘******徒步**，希望能**一睹******难觅踪迹的**灰狼的风采。

Local tourism operators **scored** big—**abundant** revenue **poured in**, giving the economy a significant boost. 当地旅游经营者**大获成功**——**丰厚的**收入**涌入**，给经济带来了显著的提振。

Ranchers, however, were **up in arms**. 然而，牧场主们却**怒不可遏。**

As wolf populations grew, so did livestock kills. 随着狼群数量的增长，牲畜被杀的数量也在增加。

Some ranchers began organizing hunts on their own. 一些牧场主开始自行组织猎杀行动。

To **defuse** the **rising tensions**, authorities were forced to introduce a **compensation** policy: ranchers who lost livestock could now **file claims**. 为了**化解******日益加剧的紧张局势**，当局被迫出台了一项**补偿**政策：失去牲畜的牧场主现在可以**提出索赔。**

This **concession** helped **soften** the opposition. 这一**让步**有助于**缓和**反对声音。

第六段

Other regions now **pursue** similar outcomes. 其他地区如今也在**追求**类似的成果。

In Germany, wolves have crossed the **border** from Poland—and the boost to ecosystem recovery is already visible. 在德国，狼群已经从波兰越过了**边境**——对生态系统恢复的推动作用已经清晰可见。

Farmers, though, have **groaned** over their **mounting** losses and **pointed fingers at** government policy. 然而，农民们却为**不断增加的**损失而**叫苦不迭**，并**将矛头******指向**政府政策。

In response, **Parliament** drew up **clauses** to safeguard their interests and property. 作为回应，**议会**制定了**条款**来保障他们的利益和财产。

The **entity** responsible for overseeing wildlife **conceded** limited culls—but kept core populations **intact**. 负责监管野生动物的**机构******同意**进行有限的猎杀——但保持核心种群**完好无损。**

第七段

Ecologists **counsel** patience. 生态学家们**建议**保持耐心。

After all, ecosystem recovery is not **instantaneous**—it takes decades to restore the **delicate bonds** between species. **毕竟**，生态系统的恢复不是**一蹴而就的**——恢复物种之间的**微妙纽带**需要几十年的时间。

Yet for all this complexity, Yellowstone offers a **concise** lesson: remove a keystone species, the balance collapses; **revive** it, nature **heals** itself. 然而，尽管如此复杂，黄石公园提供了一个**简明的**教训：移除一个关键物种，平衡就会崩溃；**恢复**它，自然就会自我**愈合。**